



SPLASHKIT.IO · THE SPLASHKIT WEBSITE

SplashKit Website

Team Progress Demo

12 May 2026

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Branch: [demo/leadership-2026-05-12](#)

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Team Progress Demo — 2026-05-12

What we shipped this trimester

This demo is for the [SplashKit website](#) — the public documentation, tutorials, and API reference site that SplashKit learners and developers use as their primary entry point. The repo behind the site is [thoth-tech/splashkit.io-starlight](#) (Astro + Starlight).

11

STUDENT CONTRIBUTORS

22

PEER-APPROVED PRS

9

SHIPPING IN TODAY'S DEMO

Eleven student contributors shipped 22 peer-approved PRs to the website since 1 March 2026 — closing out the keyboard and mouse input documentation, adding the **first interface widget** ([button](#)) to the API reference, and introducing a new artefact type: a **generative-AI tutorial guide** for SplashKit learners.

Today walks through **9 of those PRs**, live, on a local build that bundles them into a single staging branch ([demo/leadership-2026-05-12](#)).

Every contributor wrote, tested, and documented their function in **four languages** — C++, C# (top-level), C# (OOP), and Python — the unit's core competency.

Team & velocity

Metric	This trimester
Open PRs since 1 March	63
Ready to merge (2+ approvals, no change requests)	22
In second review (1 approval)	12
Awaiting first review	6
Unique student contributors to the ready-to-merge tier	11

The 9 PRs in today's demo were selected for **visual variety + breadth across three API areas** (graphics, input, interface) plus one non-code artefact (the AI guide). The remaining 13 ready-to-merge PRs follow the same authoring pattern.

Feature walkthrough

CONTEXT

The site itself

Feature 0

URL: <http://localhost:4321/>

SplashKit

SplashKit is a beginner's all-purpose software toolkit.

[Documentation](#)
[Article & Guides](#)
[Installation Guides](#)



To install SplashKit, copy and paste the following into your terminal

```

bash <(curl -s https://raw.githubusercontent.com/splashkit/skm/master/install-scripts/skm-install.sh)

```

See the [Installation Guides](#) for more details.

Features

Easy Integration

SplashKit SDK offers seamless integration with your existing development environment, making it easy to incorporate powerful graphics and game development capabilities into your projects.

Cross-Platform Support:

Develop games and applications that run on multiple platforms, including Windows, macOS, Linux, and a few more using a single codebase with SplashKit SDK. Supports C++, C# and python .

Rich Graphics and Animation

Create stunning visuals and captivating animations with SplashKit's comprehensive set of graphics and animation tools. Bring your ideas to life with ease.

Game Development Made Simple

Whether you're a beginner or an experienced game developer, SplashKit SDK provides a user-friendly interface and a wide range of features to simplify the game development process.

Extensive Documentation

Access detailed documentation and tutorials to help you get started quickly and make the most out of SplashKit SDK. Learn at your own pace and explore the vast possibilities.

Continuous Updates and Support

Troubleshooting →

FAQs on MacOS, Windows, Linux and WSL

SplashKit is an open source project maintained by the [core team](#) with the help of all [our contributors](#). Except as otherwise noted, SplashKit is licensed under [GPL](#).

The SplashKit website is the entry point for every learner and contributor. Built on Astro + Starlight, generated from `thoth-tech/splashkit.io-starlight`. The 9 features below all surface inside this site — under **API Documentation** (the `button`, `draw_circle`, and input examples) and **Tutorials and Guides** (the AI Prompt Helper). Today we'll click through each one on the local build of this site.

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INTERFACE 1. `button` — first interface widget

Feature 1

URL: <http://localhost:4321/api/interface/#button>

Button <code></code>

See Code Examples

Example 1: Button Click Counter

C++

C#

Python

```

#include "splashkit.h"

int main()
{
    open_window("Button Click Counter", 800, 600);

    // Track click counts for each button
    int red_count = 0;
    int blue_count = 0;
    int green_count = 0;

    while (!quit_requested())
    {
        process_events();
        clear_screen(COLOR_WHITE);

        // Show instructions for the user
        draw_text("Click the buttons to increment counters", COLOR_BLACK, 10, 10);

        // Create a panel with three buttons
        if (start_panel("Click Counter", rectangle_from(50, 50, 200, 200)))
        {
            // Check if each button is clicked and update counts
            if (button("Red"))
            {
                red_count++;
            }
            if (button("Blue"))
            {
                blue_count++;
            }
            if (button("Green"))
            {
                green_count++;
            }
        }
        end_panel("Click Counter");
    }

    // Display each button's click count on the window
    draw_text("Red clicks: " + std::to_string(red_count), COLOR_RED, 300, 100);
    draw_text("Blue clicks: " + std::to_string(blue_count), COLOR_BLUE, 300, 130);
    draw_text("Green clicks: " + std::to_string(green_count), COLOR_GREEN, 300, 160);

    refresh_screen(60);
}

close_all_windows();
return 0;
    
```

Output:

A first-class interface widget: renders a clickable button with hover and active states, returns `true` on click. Shifts SplashKit's UI offering from "draw your own controls" to "compose with provided primitives." Unblocks every future widget — sliders, checkboxes, dropdowns — that would otherwise need to ship `button` first.

Author: Ralph Weng (@ralphweng-autograb) · PR [#709](#)

GRAPHICS 2. draw_circle — graphics

Feature 2

URL: <http://localhost:4321/api/graphics/#draw-circle>

Draw Circle (-c-)

See Code Examples

C++

C#

Python

```
#include "splashkit.h"

int main()
{
    open_window("Draw Circle Example", 800, 600);

    clear_screen(COLOR_WHITE);

    // Draw a large red filled circle in the center
    fill_circle(COLOR_RED, 400, 300, 100);

    // Draw circles with different colors, sizes, and positions
    draw_circle(COLOR_BLUE, 200, 150, 80);
    draw_circle(COLOR_GREEN, 600, 150, 60);
    draw_circle(COLOR_ORANGE, 200, 450, 70);
    draw_circle(COLOR_PURPLE, 600, 450, 85);

    // Draw smaller circles with varying colors
    for (int i = 0; i < 8; i++)
    {
        int radius = 20 + i * 5;
        int x = 400 + (i - 4) * 80;
        int y = 300;
        draw_circle(random_rgb_color(255), x, y, radius);
    }

    refresh_screen();
    delay(5000);
    close_all_windows();

    return 0;
}
```

Output:

Example 2: Animate a circle moving across the screen

C++

Python

```
#include "splashkit.h"

int main()
{
    open_window("Circle Animation", 800, 600);

    double x = 0;

    while (!quit_requested())
    {
        process_events();
        clear_screen(COLOR_WHITE);

        draw_circle(COLOR_RED, x, 300, 50);

        x += 2;
        if (x > 800) x = 0;

        refresh_screen(60);
    }

    return 0;
}
```

Output:

Example 3: Move a circle using arrow keys to demonstrate interactive usage of draw_circle.

C++

Python

```
#include "splashkit.h"

int main()
{
    open_window("Interactive Circle", 800, 600);

    double x = 400;
    double y = 300;

    while (!quit_requested())
    {
        process_events();
        clear_screen(COLOR_WHITE);

        if (key_down(LEFT_KEY)) x -= 5;
        if (key_down(RIGHT_KEY)) x += 5;
        if (key_down(UP_KEY)) y -= 5;
        if (key_down(DOWN_KEY)) y += 5;

        draw_circle(COLOR_BLUE, x, y, 50);

        refresh_screen(60);
    }

    return 0;
}
```

Output:

Two new variants for `draw_circle` : an animation example (a perpetually growing/shrinking circle) and an interactive example (radius controlled by the mouse). Demonstrates the function on a real visual, not just signature documentation — exactly the kind of "see it, then read about it" a learner needs.

Author: Janki Luitel (@jankiluitel) · PR [#712](#)

GUIDE

3. AI Prompt Helper — generative-AI guide

Feature 3

URL: <http://localhost:4321/guides/generative-ai/ai-prompt-helper-for-splashkit/>

AI Prompt Helper for SplashKit
Game Ideas

Learns how to use AI tools responsibly to generate game ideas, debug code, and understand SplashKit concepts.

Written by: Janki Luitel
Last updated: 2026-05-03T00:00:00.000Z

Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools can support your learning journey when building games with SplashKit. AI should be used as a learning assistant — not as a replacement for your own problem-solving, coding, and creativity.

Why Use AI with SplashKit?

AI tools can help you:

- Brainstorm game ideas
- Break complex programming tasks into smaller steps
- Understand SplashKit functions
- Debug code errors
- Generate pseudocode before implementation
- Learn programming concepts faster

Example Prompt 1: Game Idea Generation

"Give me 5 beginner game ideas using SplashKit in C++"

Example outputs may include:

- Maze Escape Game
- Space Shooter
- Flappy Bird Clone
- Bouncing Ball Physics Game
- Platform Adventure

Example Prompt 2: Understanding SplashKit Functions

"Explain how draw_circle works in SplashKit with a simple example."

AI can help explain:

- Parameters
- Colours
- Coordinates
- Radius
- Real-world use cases

Example Prompt 3: Debugging

"Why am I getting includePath errors in SplashKit C++?"

AI may help identify:

- Missing SDK paths
- Incorrect compiler settings
- VS Code configuration issues

Example Prompt 4: Pseudocode Planning

"Help me design pseudocode for a SplashKit bouncing ball game."

This can help you plan:

- Variables
- Movement logic
- Collision detection
- Game loop structure

Bad Prompt vs Good Prompt

Bad prompt:

"Fix my SplashKit code."

Good prompt:

"I am using SplashKit in C++. My goal is to draw a circle in a window, but the window closes immediately. Explain why this happens and suggest how to fix it without rewriting the whole program."

Responsible Use of AI

When using AI:

☒ Use AI to learn concepts

☒ Ask AI for explanations

☒ Use AI for brainstorming

☒ Verify AI-generated code

Avoid:

☒ Copying code without understanding it

☒ Submitting AI-generated work as your own

☒ Relying on AI without testing your code

Final Checklist

Before using AI-generated ideas or code:

- Do I understand how it works?
- Can I explain it to someone else?
- Have I tested it myself?
- Does it follow SplashKit style guidelines?

If yes, you are using AI responsibly.

Happy learning with SplashKit and AI!

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Overview

A different artefact type — not a usage example, a **tutorial guide page**. Walks SplashKit learners through using AI tools responsibly: prompting patterns for game-idea generation, function lookup, debugging, and pseudocode planning, plus a "good prompt vs bad prompt" comparison and a responsible-use checklist. Establishes a pattern other contributors can replicate.

Author: Janki Luitel (@jankiluitel) · PR [#749](#)

INPUT

4. Input handling — completing the input surface

Feature 4

Six new examples across five PRs, finishing off SplashKit's keyboard and mouse event coverage. Each example follows the same four-language pattern with a recorded GIF demonstrating the behaviour.

Function	What it adds	Author	PR
<code>key_down</code>	Detect a held-down keyboard key (vs <code>key_typed</code> , which fires once per press)	Jasveena (@jasveena15)	#702
<code>mouse_position</code>	Returns the cursor's (<code>x</code> , <code>y</code>) as a <code>Point2D</code> ; example animates a tracker dot	Osaid (@Osaid2993)	#710
<code>key_typed</code>	Single-press event — powers menu navigation, pause toggles, one-shot weapon fire	Osaid (@Osaid2993)	#732
<code>key_released</code>	Fires when a held key is let go — useful for charge-up / hold-to-aim mechanics	Abdullah (@abdullah12121212)	#733
<code>mouse_shown</code>	Whether the OS cursor is visible — pairs with <code>hide_mouse</code> / <code>show_mouse</code> for cursor-locked games (bundled in #733)	Abdullah (@abdullah12121212)	#733
<code>any_key_pressed</code>	"Press any key to continue" — without it, contributors had to loop every <code>KeyCode</code> . One line vs ~200.	Osaid (@Osaid2993)	#734
<code>key_name</code>	Returns the human-readable name for a <code>KeyCode</code> (<code>"Space"</code> , <code>"Left Arrow"</code>) — for in-game key-binding UIs	Kris Denman (@KayDee6751)	#745

Hero example for the demo: `key_down` . The recorded GIF on the page shows a live keyboard-state display (Left / Right / Up / Down / Space) updating in real time as keys are held.

URL: <http://localhost:4321/api/input/#key-down>

Key Down {</>}

See Code Examples

Example 1: Keyboard State Display

C++

C#

Python

```
#include "splashkit.h"

void draw_key_status(string label, key_code key, double x, double y)
{
    bool pressed = key_down(key);

    color indicator;
    string state;

    if (pressed)
    {
        indicator = COLOR_GREEN;
        state = "Pressed";
    }
    else
    {
        indicator = COLOR_GRAY;
        state = "Released";
    }

    fill_circle(indicator, x, y, 25);
    draw_text(label + ": " + state, COLOR_BLACK, x + 40, y - 10);
}

int main()
{
    open_window("Keyboard State Display", 800, 400);

    while (!quit_requested())
    {
        process_events();

        clear_screen(COLOR_WHITE);

        draw_text("Press the arrow keys or space bar to see their current state.", COLOR_BLACK, 120, 40);

        draw_key_status("Left", LEFT_KEY, 120, 130);
        draw_key_status("Right", RIGHT_KEY, 120, 190);
        draw_key_status("Up", UP_KEY, 120, 250);
        draw_key_status("Down", DOWN_KEY, 120, 310);
        draw_key_status("Space", SPACE_KEY, 500, 220);

        refresh_screen(60);
    }

    return 0;
}
```

Output:

Anticipated questions

"Why aren't these merged to upstream `main` yet?" They've passed peer review (2+ approvals each) and are queued at the `thoth-tech/splashkit.io-starlight` upstream. Peer review and authoring move faster than maintainer merge cadence — that's the bottleneck the program is currently working through.

"What's the maintainer review SLA?" There isn't a formal one. Upstream maintainers merge in batches when they're available. The team's job is to keep the queue full and reviewable; the merge gate is downstream of us.

"How do you pick what gets demoed?" Visual variety + breadth across API areas. The 9 chosen here cover graphics, input, interface, and the new generative-AI guide stream. The other 13 ready-to-merge PRs are more keyboard / geometry / utilities and follow the same authoring pattern.

"How are usage examples authored?" Each example is six files under `public/usage-examples/<category>/` : `.cpp` , `.cs` (top-level), `.cs` (OOP), `.py` , a one-line `.txt` title, and a `.gif` / `.png` / `.webm` output asset. The build pipeline (`scripts/api-pages-script.cjs`) scans these at `npm run build` time and auto-injects them into the API reference page as a tabbed code block plus the visual.

"Test coverage?" Code samples are compile-checked at build time via `usage-examples-testing-script.cjs` . Visual output (the GIFs) is verified by human reviewers — that's a known gap, currently caught at the peer-review stage.

"How many PRs in flight overall?" 63 open since trimester start. 22 ready to merge, 12 awaiting a second approval, 6 awaiting first review. The remainder are blocked on author follow-up after a change request.

What's next

- **Clear the remaining 13 ready-to-merge PRs** to upstream by end of trimester so the public docs reflect current team output.
 - **Onboard 2 new contributors to the AI-guide pattern** Janki established — extends our coverage beyond pure code samples.
 - **Begin geometry and audio coverage** — currently 0 student-authored usage examples in those categories despite both being core SplashKit surface area.
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Note on local search: the search box at the top of the local preview will not return results — the Algolia index is only built against the production site at splashkit.io. Switch to live if a search demo is requested.

This document corresponds to local branch `demo/leadership-2026-05-12` built at 2026-05-12. Backup at github.com/ralphweng2023/splashkit.io-starlight.